

Air Liquide (AIRP.PA): 1H26 comes in line with step up in EL growth and IM pricing; 2H commentary light vs. Street

Air Liquide reported 1H26 results this morning (July 28), with 2Q26 G&S comp. growth above Vara Consensus (3.3% vs. 2.9%) and 1H26 OIR 1% above Vara Consensus. We highlight our key takeaways below:

Comparable growth in 2Q26: G&S comp. growth of 3.3% came in above Vara Consensus, driven by slightly better Industrial Merchant and materially better Electronics growth. Comp. growth in Large Industries was in line with Visible Alpha Consensus (-0.3% comp. growth vs. Cons -0.2% and -0.2% in 1Q26). Industrial Merchant comp. growth of 3.8% was above Visible Alpha Consensus 3.3% and vs. 2.7% in 1Q26. Industrial Merchant pricing was 5.0% in 2Q26, up from 3.4% in Q126. Healthcare comp. growth was 4.4%, vs. Visible Alpha Consensus at 4.4%, and Electronics comp. growth accelerated to 9.5% vs. Visible Alpha Consensus at 4.6%.

Earnings in 1H: Group OIR of €2,845mn was 1% above Vara Consensus for a 20.9% margin (vs. 21.1% Vara Consensus and 21.5% in 2H25).

Cash performance: Operating cash flow in 1H26 came in at €3,372mn, a 13% increase y/y, and cash conversion (OCF/EBITDA) was 84% in 1H26 vs. 96% in 2H25 and 74% in 1H25.

Efficiency gains: Structural efficiencies reached €157mn in 2Q26 (€299mn for 1H26), up 11% from the €142mn in 1Q26.

Investment opportunities: The NTM investment opportunities increased to €4.8bn (vs. €4.5bn in 1Q26 and €4.1bn at in 2Q25), of which more than 50% represents opportunities in electronics (from 40%). Air Liquide reported an all-time high industrial decisions and >€1bn of EL successes in Carrier Gases.

FY26 Outlook: Air Liquide confirmed its FY26 guidance for further increased operating margin +100bps OIR margin improvement in FY26/27 and +560bps over 2022-27 as well as recurring net profit growth in 2026 at constant exchange rates.

GS View

An in-line print. The guidance for comp growth in 2H26 to be “similar to, or slightly higher than, that of H1” (2.6%) is softer than the 5%+ that consensus/GS are looking for. Some strong positives to take from the print today are the notable step up in EL comp growth to close to 10%, as well as the step up in IM pricing sequentially. OIR margins are already tracking up 110 bps y/y vs. the 100bps improvement guided to

Georgina Fraser, Ph.D.

+44(20)7552-5984 |
georgina.fraser@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Marcus von Scheele

+44(20)7774-7676 |
marcus.vonscheele@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Thomas Ward

+44(20)7051-2527 |
thomas.ward@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Gabriel Simoes

+44(20)7051-6922 |
gabriel.simoes@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

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for 2026. Cash came in line on OCF and a beat at FCF (due to lower capex). We expect investors to take well the strength of the backlog and NTM of opportunities, especially the clear momentum in Electronics/Carrier Gases projects. As we have seen for quality growth names reporting already this quarter, in-line might not be enough to support the shares today given the c.9% outperformance vs the SX4P YTD, even if there is a lot to like from a mid-term perspective.

The conference call will be held at 10am UK time.

Exhibit 1: Air Liquide 2Q26 results vs. GSe and Consensus

Gas & Services sub-segments on Visible Alpha; remainder on Vara Consensus

Air Liquide Q2-26									
Euro mn	2Q 2025 act	1Q 2026 act	2Q 2026 est	2Q 2026 act	% chg yoy	% chg qoq	Consensus	Actuals vs. GSe	Actuals vs. Consensus
Sales									
Gas & Services	6,479	6,596	6,764	6,812	5.1%	3.3%	6,801	0.7%	0.2%
Comp growth (%)	1.8%	1.9%	3.3%	3.3%			2.9%	5 bps	40 bps
Large Industries	1,741	1,834	1,771	1,869	7.4%	1.9%	1,867	5.5%	0.1%
Comp growth (%)	1.0%	-0.9%	-1.0%	-0.3%			-0.2%	70 bps	-7 bps
Industrial Merchant	3,050	3,022	3,190	3,123	2.4%	3.3%	3,199	-2.1%	-2.4%
Comp growth (%)	1.8%	2.7%	4.5%	3.8%			3.3%	-70 bps	48 bps
Healthcare	1,088	1,112	1,132	1,132	4.0%	1.8%	1,147	0.0%	-1.3%
Comp growth (%)	4.8%	4.0%	4.5%	4.4%			4.4%	-10 bps	-5 bps
Electronics	600	628	672	688	14.7%	9.6%	652	2.4%	5.5%
Comp growth (%)	-1.6%	2.9%	7.0%	9.5%			4.6%	250 bps	493 bps
Total Group sales	6,694	6,786	6,986	7,042	5.2%	3.8%	7,030	0.8%	0.2%
Comp growth (%)	1.9%	1.8%	3.2%	3.5%	87.7%	90.0%	2.8%	25 bps	70 bps

Source: Vara Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Air Liquide 1H26 results vs. GSe and Consensus

Gas & Services sub-segments on Visible Alpha; remainder on Vara Consensus

Air Liquide 1H 2026									
Euro mn	1H 25 Act.	2H 25 Act.	1H 2026 Est.	1H 2026 Act.	% chg yoy	% chg hoh	Consensus	Actuals vs. Consensus	
Sales									
Gas & Services	13,309	12,776	13,360	13,408	0.7%	4.9%	13,396	0.1%	
Comp growth (%)	1.8%	2.2%	2.6%	2.6%			2.4%	20 bps	
Large industries	3,701	3,410	3,605	3,703	0.1%	8.6%	3,707	-0.1%	
Comp growth (%)	0.3%	0.0%	-0.9%	-0.6%			-0.6%	-3 bps	
Industrial Merchant	6,193	5,938	6,212	6,144	-0.8%	3.5%	6,216	-1.2%	
Comp growth (%)	1.6%	2.7%	3.6%	3.2%			3.1%	15 bps	
Healthcare	2,191	2,186	2,244	2,244	2.4%	2.7%	2,265	-0.9%	
Comp growth (%)	5.0%	5.0%	4.2%	4.2%			4.4%	-19 bps	
Electronics	1,224	1,242	1,300	1,317	7.6%	6.0%	1,280	2.9%	
Comp growth (%)	0.9%	1.5%	4.9%	6.2%			3.0%	316 bps	
Total Group sales	13,722	13,218	13,772	13,828	0.8%	4.6%	13,815	0.1%	
Comp growth (%)	2.0%	2.1%	2.5%	2.6%			2.3%	30 bps	
EBIT (recurring)	2,737	2,845	3,002	2,893	5.7%	1.7%	2,908	-0.5%	
Group margin	19.9%	21.5%	21.8%	20.9%			21.1%	-13 bps	
Operating cashflow	2,977	3,878	n/a	3,372	13.3%	-13.1%	3318	1.6%	
Capital Expenditure	(1,836)	(2,007)	n/a	(1,828)	-0.4%	-8.9%	(1,970)	-7.2%	
FCF	1,141	1,871	n/a	1,544	35.3%	-17.5%	1,348	14.5%	

Source: Vara Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation & Risks

Valuation

We are Buy rated on Air Liquide, with a 12-month price target of €179. Our price target is derived using a two-stage DCF, assuming a WACC of 7.8% and 3.0% terminal growth

rate.

Risks

Downside risks to our view and price target include:

- Prolonged economic downturn on the back of global tariff regime impacting Air Liquide's end markets.
- Continued weakening of the USD against the EUR.
- Material delays in project start-ups.
- Pricing pressure in the European/US healthcare markets.
- Pricing pressure in Industrial Merchant.
- New entrants to the Industrial Merchant competitive landscape.
- Slower-than-expected US IP.
- Slower-than-expected build-out of decarbonization infrastructure/semiconductor fabs.
- Value-destructive M&A.

AIRP.PA	12m Price Target: €179.00	Price: €177.18	Upside: 1.0%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: €112.4bn / \$127.8bn Enterprise value: €122.5bn / \$139.4bn 3m ADTV: €159.4mn / \$184.1mn France Europe Chemicals M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (€ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBIT (€ mn)	26,940.0	28,006.9	29,700.9	31,422.6
	EPS (€)	5,581.4	6,233.6	6,979.7	7,572.8
	P/E (X)	5.90	6.60	7.49	8.18
	EV/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	26.7	26.8	23.7	21.7
	Dividend yield (%)	13.6	14.1	12.9	12.0
	FCF yield (%)	2.1	2.0	2.1	2.2
	CROCI (%)	2.5	3.1	2.6	2.9
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	8.9	9.0	9.4	9.6
		1.1	0.9	0.8	0.7
	EPS (€)	12/25	6/26E	12/26E	6/27E
		3.01	3.17	3.43	3.65

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 27 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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Contributing Authors: Georgina Fraser, Ph.D. Goldman Sachs International, Marcus von Scheele Goldman Sachs International, Thomas Ward Goldman Sachs International, Gabriel Simoes Goldman Sachs International.

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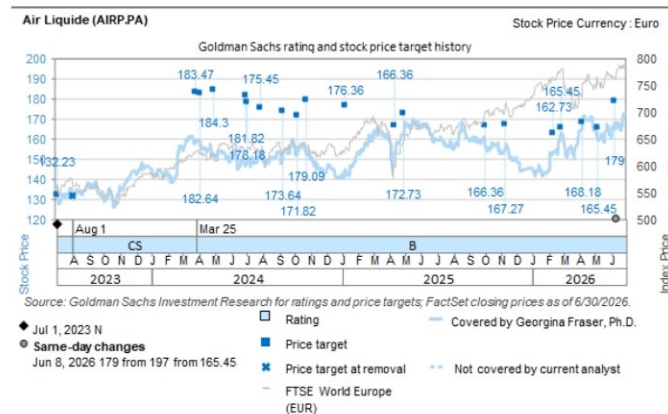
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Target price history table(s)

Air Liquide (AIRP.PA)

Date of report Target price (€) Closing price (€)

08-Jun-26	179.00	165.38
07-May-26	182.00	160.64
07-Apr-26	185.00	165.00
25-Feb-26	182.00	162.09
10-Feb-26	179.00	153.96
11-Nov-25	184.00	156.00
02-Oct-25	183.00	160.53
28-Apr-25	190.00	162.00
11-Apr-25	183.00	153.04
08-Jan-25	194.00	143.31
24-Oct-24	197.00	152.64
08-Oct-24	189.00	153.55
10-Sep-24	191.00	153.62
29-Jul-24	193.00	150.45
03-Jul-24	196.00	149.27
30-Jun-24	200.00	146.62
29-Apr-24	223.00	152.40
05-Apr-24	221.00	154.96
25-Mar-24	222.00	158.03

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